Practical 8

Elimination Need

8.1 Offering and Removing of bed pan

Bed patients usually need to use a bedpan about once or three times a day. The ward may be closed with a screen for this purpose as a routine. However if a patient makes request for a bedpan at another time, you should meet the request with understanding and without delay.

Method of giving a bedpan

1) Screen the bed.
2) Bring a covered bedpan to the bedside and place it on the stool. The bedpan should be clean and dry. In cold weather, warm if first with hot water pad the seat of the bedpan. If the patient is very weak and emaciated.
3) Protect the bed with a rubber sheet if necessary.
4) Place the bedpan on the bedside of the patient.
5) Place your left hand beneath the lower back to aid the patient in raising the buttocks and place the bedpan in position without force. Adjust the bedpan comfortably for the patient. Lower and leave him alone unless he is too ill or weak.
6) Get a toilet tray ready and bring it to the bedside.

Contents of the tray are

S. No.	Items
1.	Jug with warm water
2.	Soap
3.	Wash cloth and towel
4.	Bowl with rag pieces or cotton
5.	Long artery forceps.
6.	Kidney tray and paper bag

To Remove and empty the bed pan:-

1) Let the patient wash himself if he is able to do so. Help him pouring water over the genitals. Remove the bedpan and give the patient water and soap for hand washing.
2) If the patient is helpless use moistened rag pieces or cotton and the artery forceps and clean from front to back to prevent a infection. Turn him on his side while removing the bedpan (a second person may be needed to help).
3) Make the patient comfortable.
4) Cover the bedpan, take it to the toilet room.
5) Observe the contents.

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